

The baseline pipeline, end to end

Two repositories. The only thing that travels between them is a version tag.

IN FIGMA

- 1 A designer changes a variable. This is the only place a value is ever authored.

IN THE PIPELINE REPO · {client}-token-pipeline

- 2 Start the listener, then press Sync in the plugin. The variables land on disk as a dump.

```
npm run sink
```

- 3 Read the audit. This writes nothing.

```
npm run sync:figma -- --dry-run
```

- 4 Apply it. This writes **tokens/*.json**, the DTCG source.

```
npm run sync:figma
```

- 5 Build and gate. Produces **dist/{light,dark}/** and refuses if a check is red.

```
npm test
```

- 6 Commit source and **dist/** together, then bump the version and tag it.

```
npm run tag
```

Nothing has reached their product yet. A tag is a marker sitting in a repository.

IN THE SITE REPO · {client}-site

- 7 Their developer bumps the pin in **package.json** to the new tag. A deliberate act.

```
"{client}-tokens": "github:{org}/{repo}#v1.1.0"
```

- 8 Install and sync. npm install fetches that exact tag into node_modules; the sync copies one file out of it.

```
npm install && npm run sync
```

```
node_modules/{client}-tokens/dist/light/variables.css  
-> vendor/tokens.css
```

- 9 Commit **vendor/tokens.css**. Their CI then checks that every var(--{prefix}-...) the site uses still exists.

DEPLOY

- 10 The page links **vendor/tokens.css** and ships. **No build step**, because the file is already in the repository.

Values only ever travel one way: out of Figma, into the pipeline, into the site. Nothing writes back.

The tag is the entire interface between the two repositories. You publish; they pull.

Steps 1 to 6 are yours. Steps 7 to 10 are theirs.

That boundary is why a design change cannot surprise anyone in production, and why nothing stops working if you and they part company. There is no mechanism by which your work reaches their codebase on its own.

